task-5-Case study

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1. Case study on phishing

Phishing is a type of cybercrime in which attackers impersonate trusted organisations to trick individuals into revealing sensitive information such as passwords, banking details, or OTPs. It is one of the most common and effective online scams.

A typical phishing attack follows a clear sequence. First, the attacker sends an email, SMS, or message that appears to come from a legitimate source, such as a bank or popular website. The message usually creates urgency, for example, warning that the user's account will be blocked or hacked. Next, the victim is asked to click on a link provided in the message. This link redirects them to a fake website that closely resembles the original one. The victim then enters their login credentials or personal details, believing the site is genuine. Once submitted, the attacker captures this information and uses it for unauthorised access or financial fraud.

Phishing commonly targets students, working professionals, and general internet users, especially those who are less aware of cybersecurity risks. However, even experienced users can be deceived by well-crafted messages.

The consequences can include financial loss, identity theft, and unauthorised access to personal accounts. Victims may also face long-term privacy issues and emotional stress.

This case highlights the need for awareness. Users should verify sources, avoid clicking suspicious links, and never share sensitive information without confirming authenticity.